

Specifications

Accounting Software: How They Fared										
Details	Tally EIS 5.4	Simply Accounting	Account21	Wings2000	Easy Accounting	Arthalekha	ACE	FACT 1.9	Wings2000 PRO	EX Next Generation 1.5
Contact	Software at Work	Simply Soft Technologies	Topsys Solution P. Ltd.	Wings Infonet	Support Systems	Modular Infotech Ltd.	Coral Softwares	Vedika Software	Wings Infonet	Tata Consultancy Services
Price	Rs 22,000	Rs 5,992	Rs 12,950	Free	Rs 9,995	Rs.5,000	Rs 9,500	Rs 14,500	Rs 18,000	Rs 9,500
Phone	022-6437209	080-2384900	080-5274343	040-3211458	011-5745596	020-4223510	033-2375091	022-5006490	040-3211458	022-8774081
Fax	022-6432275	080-2384905	080-5295046	040-3237318	011-5350473	020-4225896	033-2373298	033-2400824	040-3237318	022-8777441
Email	info@software-at-work.com	enquiry@simplysofttech.com	topsys@vsnl.com	info@wings2000.com	easy@satyam.net.in	modular@giasp01.vsnl.net.in	info@coralindia.com	info@vedika.com	info@wings2000.com	jaideep_mudholkar@mumbai.tcs.co.in
Website	www.software-at-work.com	www.simplysofttech.com/		www.wings2000.com		www.arthalekha.com	www.coralindia.com	www.vedika.com	www.wings2000.com	bai.tcs.co.in
Rating	B	B+	B	A-	B-	B+	B	B+	B+	B+

Managing Personal Finances

What if you are not comfortable with all the accounting terms? What you need is a personal accounting software that takes care of things such as your daily savings and budgets, keeps track of the balances in your bank accounts, manages your stocks portfolio and even helps you with a bit of tax-planning if necessary.

Two such software that do all of this quite well and are also popular are Quicken 2001 and Microsoft Money. With their year 2001 versions, they even have many sophisticated features. Unfortunately, both these products are customised more towards the Western market, and hence many of the options and features these software use (currency, for example), may not exactly be to your liking. Features that you might want to use are the bill reminder facility and the cash-flow balance statement that Quicken and Money provide.

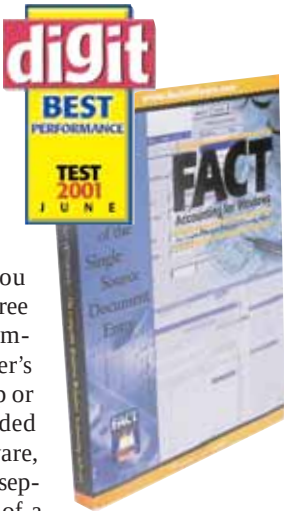
CONCLUSION

So which one is the best? While all these software provide utility, some of them lack certain features while some surpass the others in terms of implementation and ease of use. Of course, like we said earlier, it depends on what your needs are.

From our analysis, we conclude that **Wings2000** gives you the best value—it's free and it fulfils the common home user's needs. While no help or tutorials are provided with the basic software, these can be bought separately in the form of a book for a small sum. Home or office users who don't need high-end features will be more than satisfied with Simply Accounting, which boasts of

a splendid feature-list at an extremely reasonable price.

On the small-and-medium business front, Account21, Tally, FACT, Wings Pro, Ex Next Generation were all very useful, and in terms of



features and functionality, they were neck-and-neck. Among them, FACT is the most feature-rich—it gives users complete inventory control and also provides very robust reporting capabilities with highly defined and complex levels and rules. The others lost out because they lacked in totality of features and supported less accounting tasks as compared to FACT.

So **FACT** emerges the winner with very advanced features, and that too at a reasonable price. When it comes to taking care of all that expenditure and going that extra step to create reports, manage balance sheets and even plan your tax structure, opting for an accounting package like FACT is probably the best step that you can take to bring sanity to your financial management. ■

